

What Blackbaud actually sells (and what's worth cloning)

Blackbaud's Raiser's Edge NXT bundles five things that matter to small nonprofits: a constituent CRM, gift/donation processing, campaign and fund management, reporting/analytics, and event/communication tooling. The other 80% of their product (enterprise grant management, financial GL accounting, payment gateway lock-in) is what makes it expensive and is what you should *not* try to replicate. Your targets (SLCM, ChooseWell, Fletcher Group orgs) need the core, not the enterprise sprawl.

Proposed MVP scope — "MADe180 Advancement Platform"

1. Constituent CRM (the spine)

Unified `constituents` table covering donors, volunteers, board members, grantors. One person, many roles. This is your EAV pattern again — core identity fields in columns, flexible attributes in an EAV side table. Relationships (household, employer-matching, soft credits) are the part people underestimate; model them early as a `constituent_relationships` join table.

2. Donation / gift tracking

`gifts` table linked to constituents, funds, and campaigns. Gift types: one-time, recurring, pledge, in-kind, matching, stock. The critical concepts to get right are *pledges vs. payments* (a pledge is a promise; payments draw it down) and *soft credits* (spouse/foundation gets recognition without double-counting revenue). Recurring gifts need a schedule model, not just a flag.

3. Fund & campaign management

`funds` (restricted/unrestricted buckets — accounting cares deeply about this), `campaigns` (time-bound fundraising drives), and `appeals` (specific solicitations within a campaign). Every gift gets attributed to fund + campaign + appeal. This three-tier structure is exactly how Blackbaud and DonorPerfect model it, and reports collapse without it.

4. Budget & revenue tracking

Campaign goals vs. actuals, fund balances, projected vs. received pledge revenue. Recharts dashboards — you've built this exact thing for DDOR outcomes.

5. Reporting

Gift detail, LYBUNT/SYBUNT (Last/Some Year But Unfortunately Not This — the donor-lapse reports that drive nonprofit fundraising), campaign performance, year-end tax receipts (jsPDF, you already do this).

6. Dori-style AI assistant

Natural-language queries over the data: "who lapsed since last year," "draft a thank-you for this gift." Direct reuse of your Anthropic SDK pattern.

Things that will bite you — flag now

- **Tax receipting compliance** — IRS substantiation rules for gifts over \$250, quid-pro-quo disclosures for events. Get the receipt language right; nonprofits will rely on it.

- **PCI scope** — do not store card numbers. Use Stripe/Stripe-hosted; you keep only tokens and last-four. This keeps you out of PCI hell entirely.
- **Don't build a general ledger.** Integrate with / export to QuickBooks instead. The moment you do GL accounting you've signed up for a different, much harder product.
- **Deduplicati**